The committee met on the fourth of March to review the proposed changes to the harbour regulations. Members noted that the existing rules had not been revised since the nineteen nineties and no longer matched the way the port is used today. Cargo volumes have roughly doubled, and the pilot service now runs through the night. A summary of the submissions received during the consultation period follows, grouped by theme.

Several operators asked for the berthing fees to be published a full quarter before they take effect, so that contracts can be priced against them. The harbour master agreed in principle but asked that an exception be kept for emergency repairs, where a vessel may need a berth at short notice and at a reduced rate.

Residents of the old quarter raised the matter of noise from the cranes between ten at night and six in the morning. The committee asked the harbour master to report back on options, including a limit on the number of cranes working at once, and on whether the quieter electric models could be bought through the capital fund.

The treasurer presented the accounts for the year. Income was slightly above the forecast, mostly because of the new cold store, while the cost of dredging came in under budget after the contractor finished early.

The next meeting is set for the first Tuesday of May. Papers will be circulated one week beforehand.